increasingly important. In addition to enjoying “solid friendship,” Pakistan and China shared waters and mountains, which they would “protect together.”[94] Protection of the CPEC has also been a feature of the annual Pakistan-led *Aman* (Peace) multinational naval exercises, last organised in February 2019, to which India is not invited.[95] India is investing in space sensors and naval capabilities to improve its Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA),[96] and although not necessarily directed at China, these technologies help India monitor the presence and activities of any navies in the India Ocean Region. For instance, the Indian Navy has started to deploy Boeing P-81 maritime patrol aircraft in the IOR.[97] The P-8I is a long-range anti-submarine warfare, anti-surface warfare, intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance aircraft capable of broad-area, maritime, and littoral operations. The P-8I is a variant of the P-8A Poseidon that Boeing is developing for the US Navy. The Indian Navy is the first international customer for the P-8.[98] Sightings of Chinese submarines in the Indian Ocean have reportedly decreased, possibly part of an effort by China to “reset” Sino–Indian relations following the April 2018 Wuhan meeting.[99]

Finally, India is worried about China’s growing naval capabilities. Even if the PLA Navy has acquired capabilities to challenge the US Navy in the Pacific,[100] China’s navy has lacked the power projection capabilities to play a prominent role in the Indian Ocean Region. However, this can change. China launched its first aircraft carrier, the originally Soviet-built Liaoning, in 2012, but in 2017, it launched the Type 001A, the first domestically designed and built carrier. Reports of a second Chinese-built carrier, the Type 002, emerged in early 2018.[101] The recently released US Department of Defense *Annual Report to Congress on Military and Security Developments Involving the People’s Republic of China 2019* confirms that China began